



FREE GUIDE · FOR INDEPENDENT PHARMACIES

The Independent Pharmacy's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Expired stock, controlled returns, hazardous drugs,
and immunization sharps — every stream.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

More than expired stock.

Independent pharmacies accumulate expired and returned medication stock — non-controlled, controlled, and RCRA-hazardous — that needs compliant destruction, plus immunization sharps and, increasingly, patient take-back. Sorting controlled and hazardous drugs from the rest is where compliance lives. This guide covers every stream.

The good news

One DEA-registered partner can handle your controlled returns, hazardous drugs, expired non-controlled stock, and immunization sharps — with Form 41 and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Expired and returned controlled stock, destroyed to DEA standards.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / returned Schedule II–V stock
- Damaged & recalled controlled product
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled destruction to DEA standards, with documentation.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

WASTE STREAM 02

RCRA-hazardous drugs

Common pharmacy items that are federally hazardous waste — not ordinary Rx waste.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Warfarin, nicotine & P/U-listed drugs
- Certain hormones & chemo agents
- Characteristic hazardous drugs

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous meds
- Sharps

THE RULE · EPA RCRA — hazardous drugs must be segregated from pharmaceutical waste and destroyed to EPA standards.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit.

Tip

Keep a hazardous-drug segregation list at the bench — items like warfarin and nicotine are P/U-listed.

WASTE STREAM 03

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired non-controlled, non-hazardous stock.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled Rx & OTC
- Damaged & short-dated stock
- Returned non-hazardous meds

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 04

Sharps

Immunization and in-store injection sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Immunization needles & syringes
- Lancets
- Injection sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The independent pharmacy compliance checklist.

- ☐ Controlled returns rendered non-retrievable with a Form 41.
- ☐ RCRA-hazardous drugs (warfarin, nicotine, etc.) segregated and destroyed to EPA standards.
- ☐ Expired non-controlled stock destroyed with documentation.

- ☐ Immunization sharps in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ Any patient take-back handled per DEA collector rules.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction and manifests retained per DEA, EPA, and state rules.

QUESTIONS PHARMACIES ASK

Your pharmacy questions, answered.

How do we destroy expired controlled stock?

Rendered non-retrievable with a DEA Form 41 — we're DEA-registered, so it's handled compliantly with full documentation.

Which pharmacy drugs count as hazardous waste?

P/U-listed and characteristic hazardous drugs — warfarin, nicotine products, certain hormones and chemo agents. They must be segregated from ordinary pharmaceutical waste; we'll help you build a segregation list.

Can you help with a patient take-back program?

Yes — we can support compliant destruction of collected take-back medications per DEA collector rules.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle handles your independent pharmacy's controlled returns, hazardous drugs, expired stock, and immunization sharps — with Form 41, manifests, and Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Controlled returns	Controlled destruction (Form 41)
Hazardous drugs (warfarin, nicotine)	RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit

Waste stream	The right path
Expired non-controlled stock	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Immunization sharps	Sharps mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Regular stock volume may favor scheduled pickup with manifests. We'll size it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY INDEPENDENT PHARMACIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your independent pharmacy waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop